

READING PASSAGE 3

Coral Reef Biodiversity

A Coral Reef Biodiversity has emerged as one of the most significant topics in contemporary academic discourse. The complexity and multifaceted nature of this subject have attracted the attention of researchers, policymakers, and practitioners across multiple disciplines, all seeking to understand its implications for the future.

B The intellectual lineage of this field extends considerably further than many realise. While modern research techniques have only recently been applied to these questions, philosophers and natural scientists have grappled with related issues for centuries. The transition from speculative philosophical inquiry to systematic empirical investigation represents one of the most significant developments in the intellectual history of this domain.

C At the core of current understanding lies a set of interrelated mechanisms that collectively explain the observed patterns and outcomes. First, structural factors create the underlying conditions within which individual and collective action takes place. These structural dimensions include economic incentives, institutional frameworks, and cultural norms that shape behaviour in ways that are often not immediately apparent to the actors themselves. Second, dynamic feedback processes amplify or dampen initial effects, generating patterns of change that can diverge substantially from what linear models would predict.

D Case studies from diverse geographical and cultural settings provide compelling illustrations of these dynamics in action. In one particularly well-documented example, researchers tracked developments over a fifteen-year period in a setting that offered a natural experiment in the effects of policy change. The introduction of a new regulatory framework produced a cascade of adaptations that rippled through the entire system, generating outcomes that both confirmed theoretical predictions and revealed previously unrecognised complexities.

E The practical application of research findings has proven more challenging than many initially anticipated. The translation of academic knowledge into actionable policy recommendations requires navigating a complex landscape of political constraints, economic interests, and social dynamics that academic models often simplify or overlook. Implementation failures in several high-profile initiatives have underscored the gap between theoretical understanding and practical capacity, prompting calls for more engaged and context-sensitive approaches to research.

F The future trajectory of research in this area will likely be shaped by several converging trends. Advances in computational methods and data science are opening up new analytical possibilities, enabling researchers to detect patterns and test hypotheses at scales that were previously unimaginable. Simultaneously, growing recognition of the importance of interdisciplinary collaboration is breaking down traditional barriers between fields and fostering innovative syntheses of diverse theoretical perspectives.

G The evidence reviewed above demonstrates both the substantial achievements of research in this field and the significant work that remains to be done. As new tools and theoretical perspectives become available, and as the phenomena themselves continue to evolve, the research community will need to maintain both rigour in its methods and openness to new ideas. The stakes are high, for the questions addressed by this research bear directly on some of the most important challenges facing humanity in the twenty-first century.

Questions 1–2

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

1 Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?

- A. excessive research funding
- B. translating academic findings into practical policy
- C. lack of public interest
- D. too many international collaborations

2 The passage indicates that critics have raised concerns about:

- A. too much data collection
- B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
- C. insufficient government funding
- D. overly complex statistical methods

Question 3

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

3 Dynamic _____ processes can amplify or dampen initial effects in complex systems.

Questions 4–5

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

4 The landmark study discussed in the passage involved participants from multiple countries.

5 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.

Questions 6–7

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

6 According to the passage, what is one of the key factors identified by researchers?

- A. weak effects across studies
- B. moderate to large effect sizes with consistency
- C. contradictory findings
- D. results only in specific populations

7 According to the text, what role do structural factors play?

- A. economic incentives and institutional constraints
- B. individual personality traits
- C. random chance
- D. government policies alone

Question 8

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 8 According to the text, cognitive processes shape the _____ that people make.

Question 9

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 9 Contemporary understanding of this topic is more sophisticated than it was fifty years ago.

Question 10

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 10 The author notes that researchers have called for more _____ approaches to investigation.

Question 11

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 11 Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?

- A. excessive research funding
- B. translating academic findings into practical policy
- C. lack of public interest
- D. too many international collaborations

Question 12

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 12 The landmark study analysed data spanning a period of _____ years.

Question 13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 13 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.